Conversational AI UX design

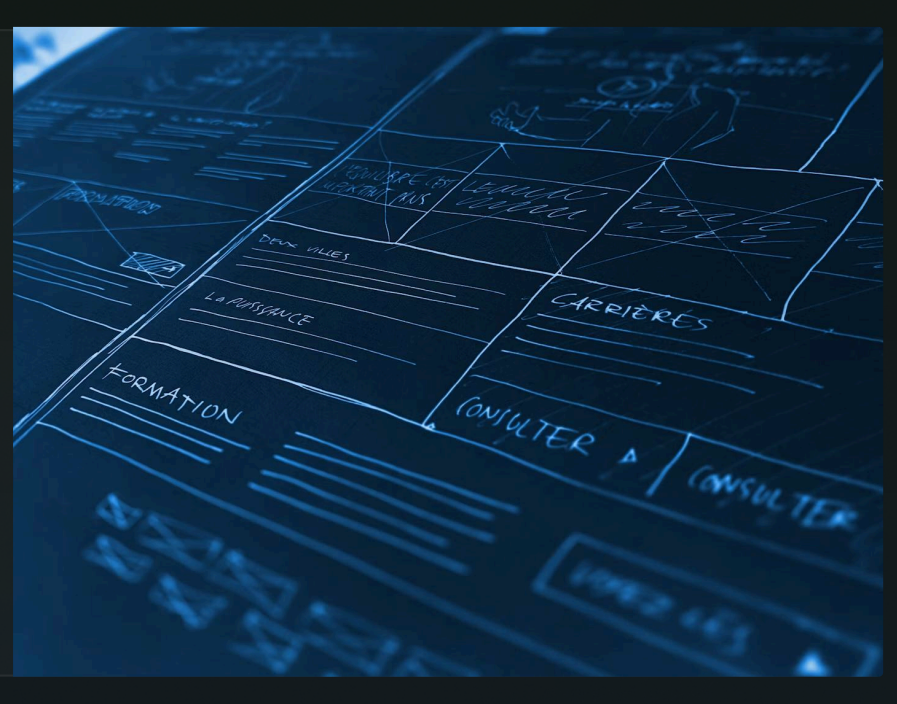
We design how people talk to your product — chatbots, voice assistants, and AI copilots that feel natural, not robotic.

Designing the dialogue, not the menu

Definition

"Talk to it — don't click through it."

Conversational AI UX design shapes how people interact through dialogue — typed or spoken — instead of clicking through menus and forms. It spans chatbots, voice assistants, and AI copilots.



What it combines

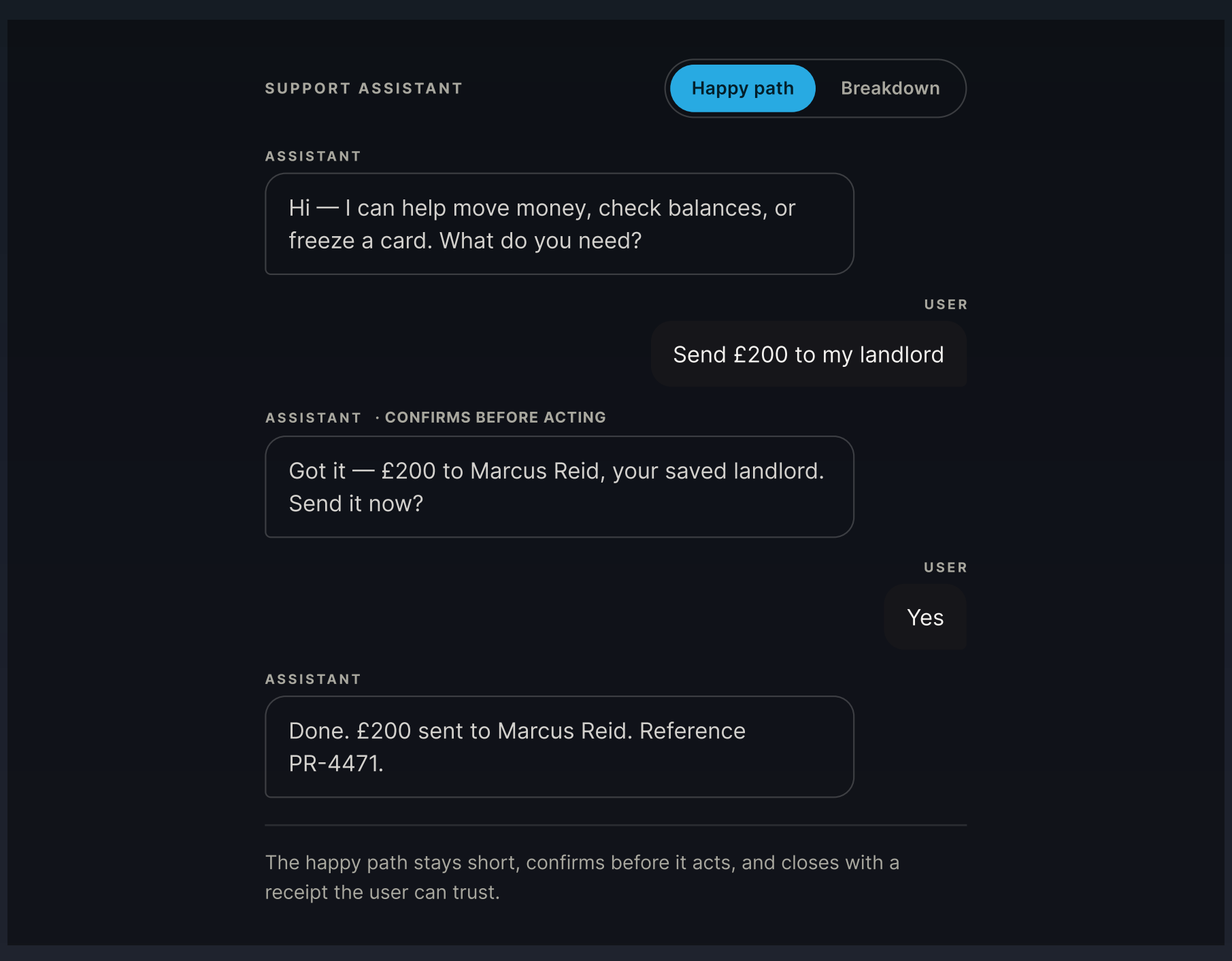
Conversation flow
The branching paths a dialogue can take, mapped before any screen.

Tone of voice
A brand personality that stays consistent across every reply.

Interaction design
The states, cues, and recovery that make it feel natural, not scripted.

The same assistant, two paths

Most conversations don't follow the script. Toggle to Breakdown to see how a well-designed flow recovers when it misunderstands.



ASSISTANT
Hi — I can help move money, check balances, or freeze a card. What do you need?

USER
Send £200 to my landlord

ASSISTANT · CONFIRMS BEFORE ACTING
Got it — £200 to Marcus Reid, your saved landlord. Send it now?

USER
Yes

ASSISTANT
Done. £200 sent to Marcus Reid. Reference PR-4471.

The happy path stays short, confirms before it acts, and closes with a receipt the user can trust.

Confidence, shown
A number and a colour, not a flat answer dressed up as fact.

Reasoning, exposed
The factors that drove the call — so a person can sanity-check it.

Control, always
Edit, override, or regenerate — the user is never stuck with the guess.

Graceful low confidence
When the model is unsure, the interface says so and defers to a human.

A good conversation is invisible — a bad one is all you remember

Lower friction for common tasks
A well-designed conversation can resolve a request faster than navigating menus or forms.

Trust depends on tone
A conversational interface that feels robotic or forced undermines confidence fast — brand voice matters here as much as logic.

Different modes, different needs
Typing and speaking have different expectations — visual feedback for chat, audio cues and hands-free flow for voice. Each needs its own design.

Recovery makes or breaks it
Conversations break down. What happens when the system doesn't understand is often what a user remembers most.

Six principles behind the work

01
Map before you draw

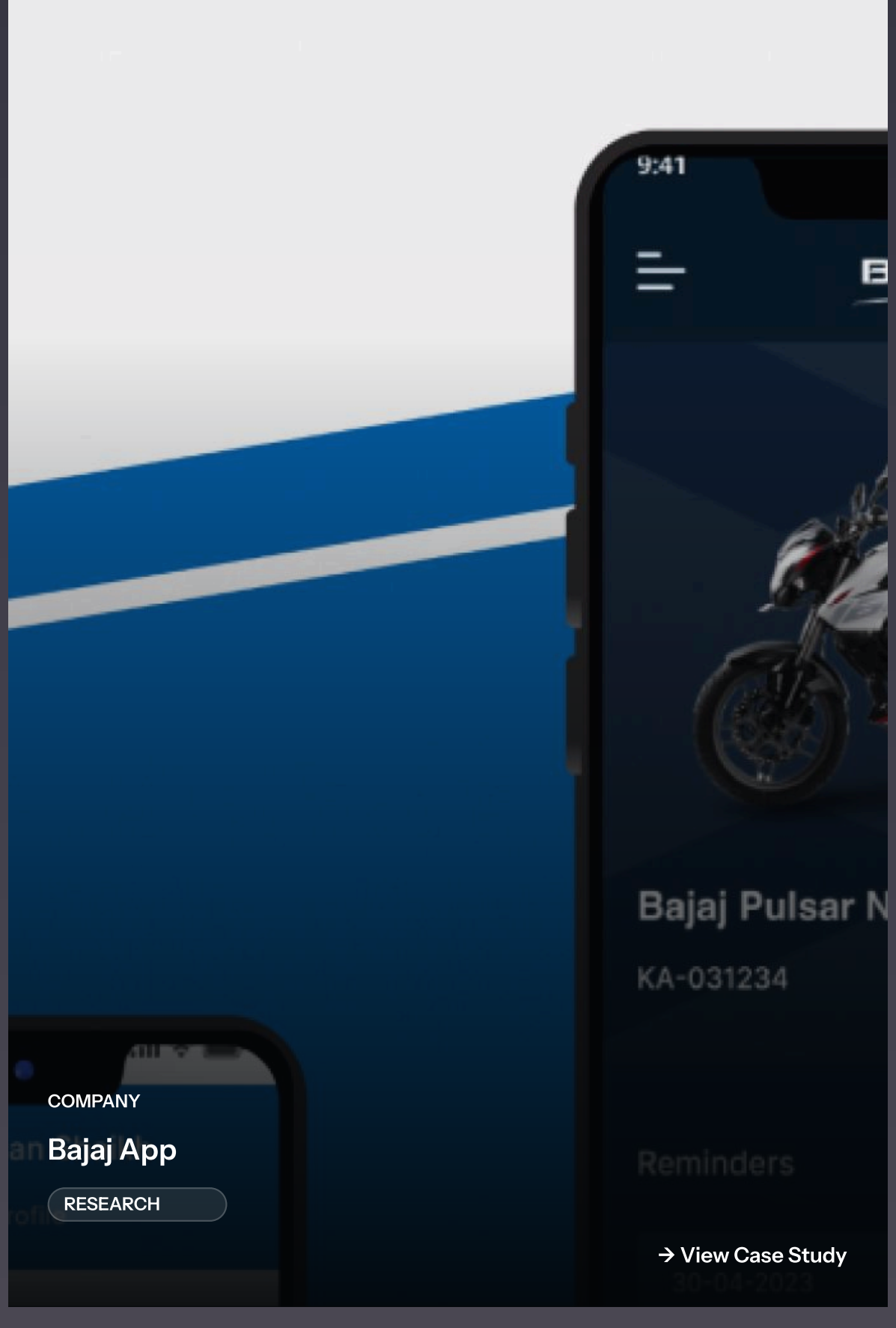
The conversation flow is designed before any screen or state.

02
Tone matches brand

03
Chat and voice apart

Designed in the wild

A few frames off the sheet — AI features built to be understood, corrected, and trusted.



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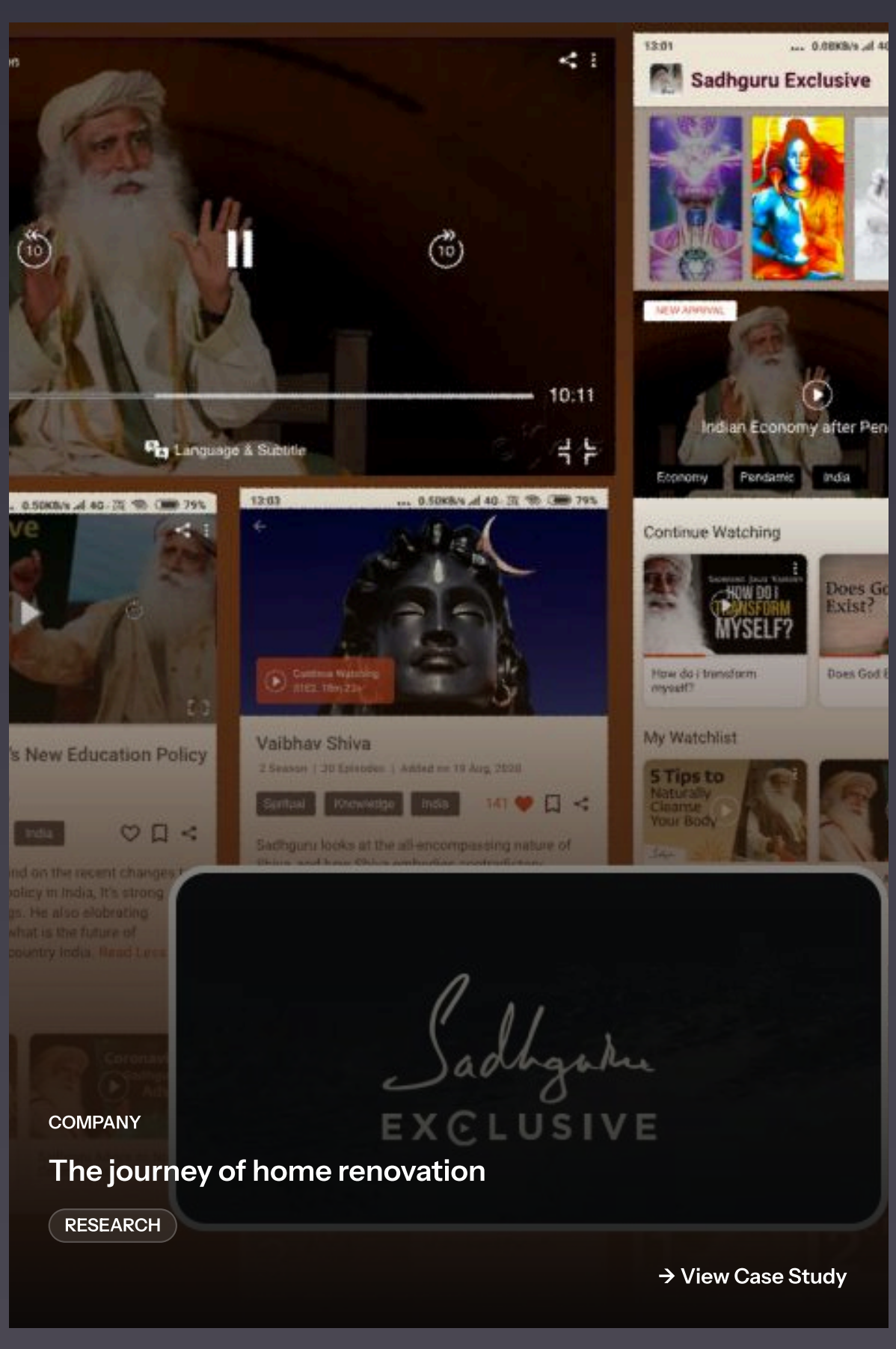

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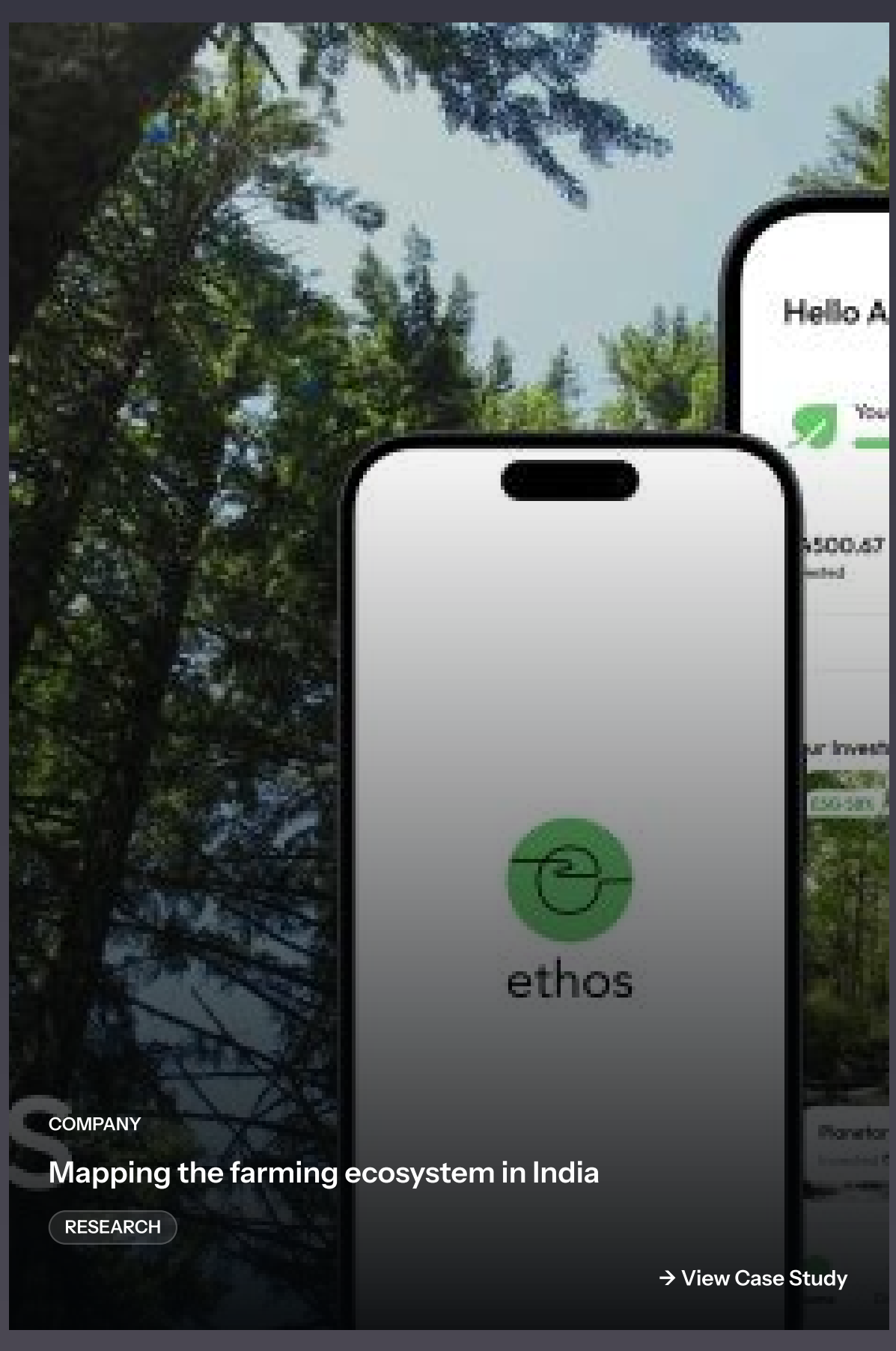

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Frequently asked questions

- What's the difference between a chatbot and a voice assistant, design-wise? +
- How do you decide what the AI should say? +
- What happens when the AI doesn't understand the user? +
- What do I get at the end? +

Want your AI to actually *sound like your product?*

Tell us what your assistant needs to do and how your brand should sound. We'll map the flows — happy path and every breakdown — and give it a voice.

Design your conversation flow

peepaldesign

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